



THE AGE OF CHANGE

1830–80

Firearms technology leaped ahead in the 19th century. Around 1830, the flintlock was still in almost universal military service, but the next 50 years saw the invention and adoption of percussion ignition, successful breech-loading mechanisms, the metallic cartridge, effective repeating firearms, and even machine-guns. Many of the mechanisms developed during that time are still in use today.